

PRIMARY 5 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

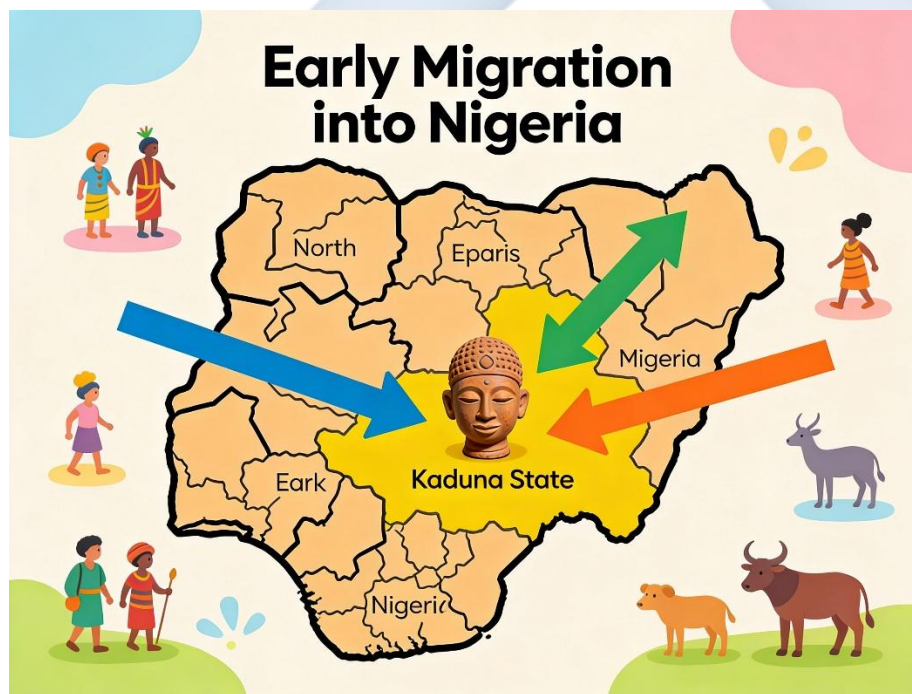
FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: ORIGINS AND PEOPLING OF NIGERIA.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define the term migration.
2. Explain how different groups settled in Nigeria.
3. Describe the Nok Culture and its location.
4. Mention the importance of archaeological evidence.

CONTENT



1. Definition of Migration:

- *Migration* is the movement of people from one place to another to settle there.
- Long ago, many of the people living in Nigeria today did not start here.

- They moved (migrated) from other parts of Africa and the Middle East in search of fertile land for farming, water, safety from wars, or good hunting grounds.
- It is like when a family moves from their old village to a new town to find better farmland or a safer place to live.

2. How Different Groups Settled in Nigeria:

- Different ethnic groups settled in Nigeria at different times, just like different families arrive at a party at different hours.
- Some groups, like the Hausa, migrated from the North and East.
- The Yoruba are believed to have migrated from the East (Mecca or Upper Egypt) and settled in Ile-Ife, which they call the cradle of their civilization.
- The Igbo have stories that suggest they have been in their land for a very long time, while others say they migrated from Israel or Egypt.
- Over hundreds of years, these groups moved, settled, and formed the communities we know today, blending together to become one big Nigerian family.

3. The Nok Culture:

- The Nok culture is one of the earliest known civilizations in Nigeria, like a great-grandparent to our modern cultures.
- It was discovered in a village called Nok in present-day Kaduna State. The Nok people lived about 2,500 years ago.
- To understand how long ago that was, if your great-great-grandparents lived 100 years ago, the Nok people lived 25 times longer ago than that!
- They were famous for making beautiful figures and heads out of baked clay, known as *terracotta*.
- They were also the first people in West Africa to smelt iron to make tools and weapons, which was a huge technological advancement at the time.

[Nok Timeline] Today ----- 500 yrs ago ----- 1000 yrs ago ----- 1500 yrs ago ----- 2000 yrs ago ----- 2500 yrs ago (NOK!) |||||_____

4. Importance of Archaeological Evidence:

- We know about the Nok people and early settlers through archaeology.
- *Archaeology* is the study of history by digging up old objects left behind by people who lived long ago.
- Think of it as being a detective looking for clues from the past.
- These objects, like pots, tools, and the Nok terracotta heads, are called *artifacts*.
- They serve as evidence or proof that helps historians understand how our ancestors lived, what they ate, and the tools they used.
- Without these artifacts, stories of the Nok might be forgotten, just like a story with no pictures or proof.

EVALUATION

1. What is migration?
2. Mention one reason why people migrated in the past.
3. Where did the Yoruba people settle?
4. In which state was the Nok culture discovered?
5. What material did the Nok people use to make their famous heads?
6. Who are archaeologists?
7. What is an artifact?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a simple map of Nigeria in your notebook and mark Kaduna State.
 2. Ask your parents where your own village ancestors migrated from and write it down.
 3. Find a picture of a Nok terracotta head and paste it in your note (or draw it if you cannot find a picture).
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WEEK 2: PRE-COLONIAL POLITICAL SYSTEMS I (CENTRALIZED STATES).

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a centralized political system.
2. List three examples of centralized kingdoms in pre-colonial Nigeria.
3. Explain the structure of government in the Oyo or Benin Kingdom.
4. State the roles of Kings and Chiefs.

CONTENT



1. Definition of Centralized Political System:

- A *centralized political system* is a type of government where power and authority are concentrated in the hands of one supreme leader, usually a King, Emperor, or Sultan.
- In this system, the leader controls the laws, the army, and the administration of the land from a central capital city.
- Imagine a big tree: the King is the strong trunk, and all the branches (provinces/villages) get their support and direction from it.

2. Examples of Centralized Kingdoms:

- Before the British came, Nigeria had powerful centralized kingdoms. Three famous examples are:
- The Benin Kingdom (ruled by the Oba).
- The Oyo Empire (ruled by the Alaafin).
- The Kanem-Bornu Empire (ruled by the Mai or Shehu).
- These kingdoms were like giant, well-organized families with a strong father (the King) at the head.

3. Structure of Government (Oyo and Benin):

- In the Oyo Empire, the Alaafin was the supreme head.
- However, he was assisted by a council of seven powerful chiefs called the Oyomesi, led by the Bashorun.
- The Oyomesi could check the power of the King to ensure he did not rule badly.
- It was a system of balance, like a headmaster (Alaafin) who has senior teachers (Oyomesi) to advise him.
- In the Benin Kingdom, the Oba was very powerful and respected as a divine ruler (seen as having a connection to the gods).
- He was assisted by groups of chiefs, such as the Uzama (kingmakers), who helped him govern the people and advise on important matters.

[Centralized System Pyramid] KING (Oba/Alaafin) | CHIEFS (Uzama/Oyomesi) | THE PEOPLE

4. Roles of Kings and Chiefs:

- The Kings (Oba, Alaafin, Shehu) and their Chiefs had important duties:
- They made laws to guide the people, just like school rules.
- They settled disputes and judged cases to ensure peace, acting as judges.
- They organized the army to defend the kingdom from enemies.

- They collected taxes or tributes (gifts/crops) to maintain the kingdom, similar to how parents provide for a home.
- They led religious festivals and offered prayers for the community's well-being.

EVALUATION

1. What is a centralized political system?
2. Who was the head of the Oyo Empire?
3. Who was the head of the Benin Kingdom?
4. Mention one example of a centralized kingdom in Nigeria.
5. What was the name of the council of chiefs in Oyo?
6. Mention two duties of Kings in pre-colonial times.
7. Who led the Oyomesi?

ASSIGNMENT

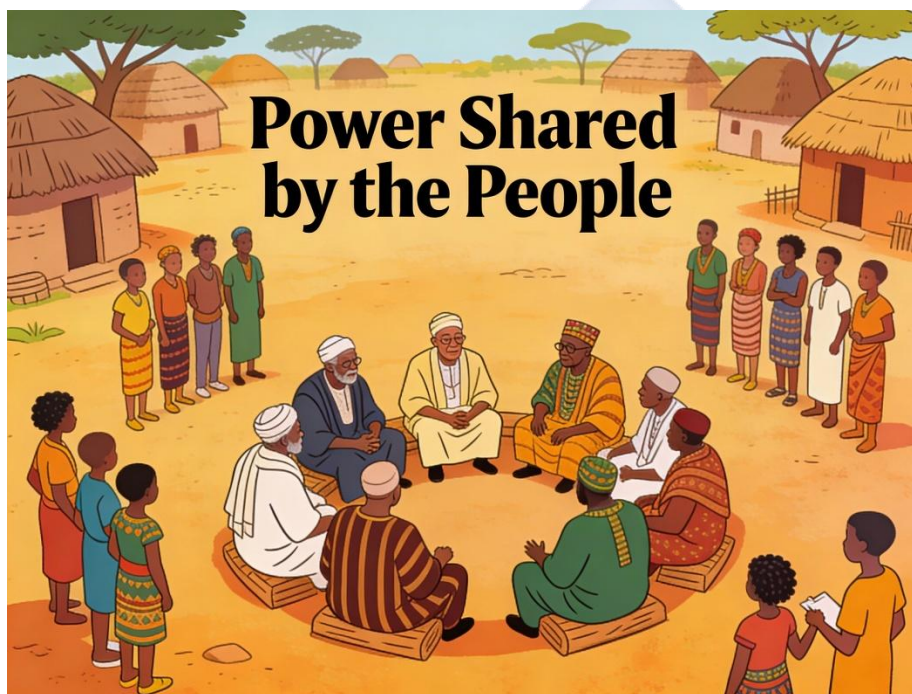
1. Write down the titles of the traditional rulers of Hausa (Emir), Yoruba (Oba), and Benin (Oba).
 2. Find out the name of the current traditional ruler of your hometown.
 3. List three qualities a good leader should have (e.g., honest, brave, wise).
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WEEK 3: PRE-COLONIAL POLITICAL SYSTEMS II (NON-CENTRALIZED STATES).

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a non-centralized political system.
2. Identify groups that practiced non-centralized systems.
3. Explain the role of Age Grades and Village Councils.
4. Describe how decisions were made in these societies.

CONTENT



1. Definition of Non-Centralized Political System:

- A *non-centralized political system* is a type of government where there is no single powerful king or leader controlling everyone.
- Instead, power is shared among the elders and the people.
- This system is also called a "republican" or "acephalous" (meaning "headless") system.
- Think of it like a football team without one captain; all senior players share responsibility.

2. Groups with Non-Centralized Systems:

- Many ethnic groups in Nigeria practiced this system before colonial rule. Major examples include:
- The Igbo people.
- The Tiv people.
- The Ibibio people.
- In these societies, every village or community was independent and ruled itself, like different compounds in a large neighborhood managing their own affairs.

3. **Role of Age Grades and Village Councils:**

- Because there were no kings, society was organized into groups to keep order:
- **Village Council:** This was a group made up of the eldest men in the families (Council of Elders). They were the highest authority and ensured peace and justice, like the grandparents in a big family making important decisions.
- **Age Grades:** These were groups of young men and women of the same age range. They performed duties like cleaning the community, building markets, defending the village during wars, and punishing people who broke the law. It was like being in a school club where everyone of the same class has special duties.

4. **Decision Making in Traditional Societies:**

- In non-centralized societies, decision-making was democratic. When a decision needed to be made, the elders would gather at the village square.
- The title holders and adult males would discuss the matter openly. Everyone had a right to speak.
- A decision was only reached when the majority of the people agreed.
- This ensured that no single person could force their will on the community.
- It was like a family meeting where everyone's opinion is heard before a choice is made.

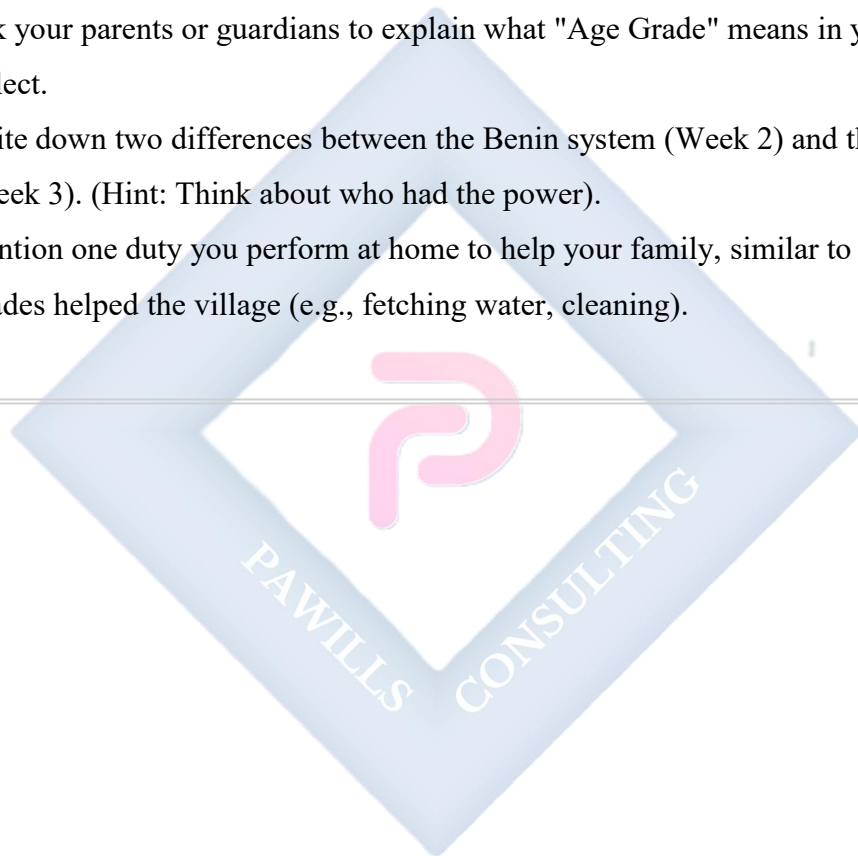
EVALUATION

1. What is a non-centralized political system?

2. Mention two ethnic groups that practiced the non-centralized system.
3. True or False: The Igbo people had a supreme king who ruled over all Igbo land.
4. What is an Age Grade?
5. Mention one duty of an Age Grade.
6. Who made up the Village Council?
7. Where did people gather to make decisions in the village?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Ask your parents or guardians to explain what "Age Grade" means in your local dialect.
2. Write down two differences between the Benin system (Week 2) and the Igbo system (Week 3). (Hint: Think about who had the power).
3. Mention one duty you perform at home to help your family, similar to how Age Grades helped the village (e.g., fetching water, cleaning).

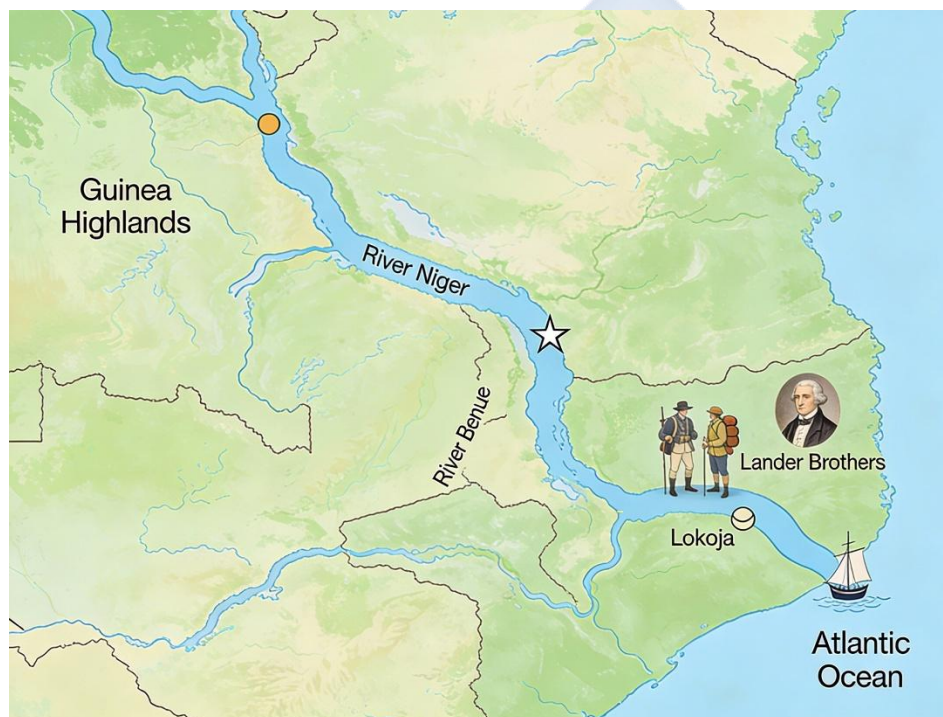


WEEK 4: THE BRITISH EXPLORATION OF NIGERIA.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify the main reason for British exploration of Nigeria.
2. Mention three famous British explorers.
3. Describe the achievements of the Lander Brothers.
4. State two impacts of these explorations.

CONTENT



1. Reason for Exploration:

- Before the British took over Nigeria, they sent explorers to find out more about the land.
- The main reason for these journeys was to find the source and the mouth (end) of the River Niger.
- They wanted to use the river as a route to travel inside Nigeria for trade, specifically to buy palm oil and sell British goods like cloth and guns.
- Rivers were the highways of that time.

2. Famous British Explorers:

- Several explorers attempted to chart the River Niger:
- **Mungo Park:** He was a Scottish doctor. He traveled twice to find the Niger. He discovered that the River Niger flows towards the East, but he died at Bussa during his second journey without finding the mouth of the river.
- **Hugh Clapperton:** He explored the Northern parts of Nigeria, including Sokoto and Borno, and wrote about the people he met.
- **Richard and John Lander (The Lander Brothers):** They finished the work Mungo Park started.

3. Achievement of the Lander Brothers:

- Richard and John Lander were the successful explorers. In 1830, they traveled down the River Niger and discovered that it flows into the Atlantic Ocean through many small rivers called the Delta.
- This was a very big discovery because it showed the British a clear water road into the heart of Nigeria for their ships.

[River Niger Flow] Source (Guinea Highlands) ----> Flows through Nigeria ----> Lokoja (meets Benue) ----> Delta ----> Atlantic Ocean (Explored by Park) (Explored by Clapperton) (Explored by Landers) (Discovered by Landers)

4. Impact of Exploration:

- The work of these explorers changed Nigeria in the following ways:
- It opened up the interior of Nigeria to international trade. Goods could now move in and out more easily.
- Christian missionaries followed the explorers to preach Christianity and build schools.
- It paved the way for the British government to eventually colonize and rule Nigeria, as they now knew the land and its routes.

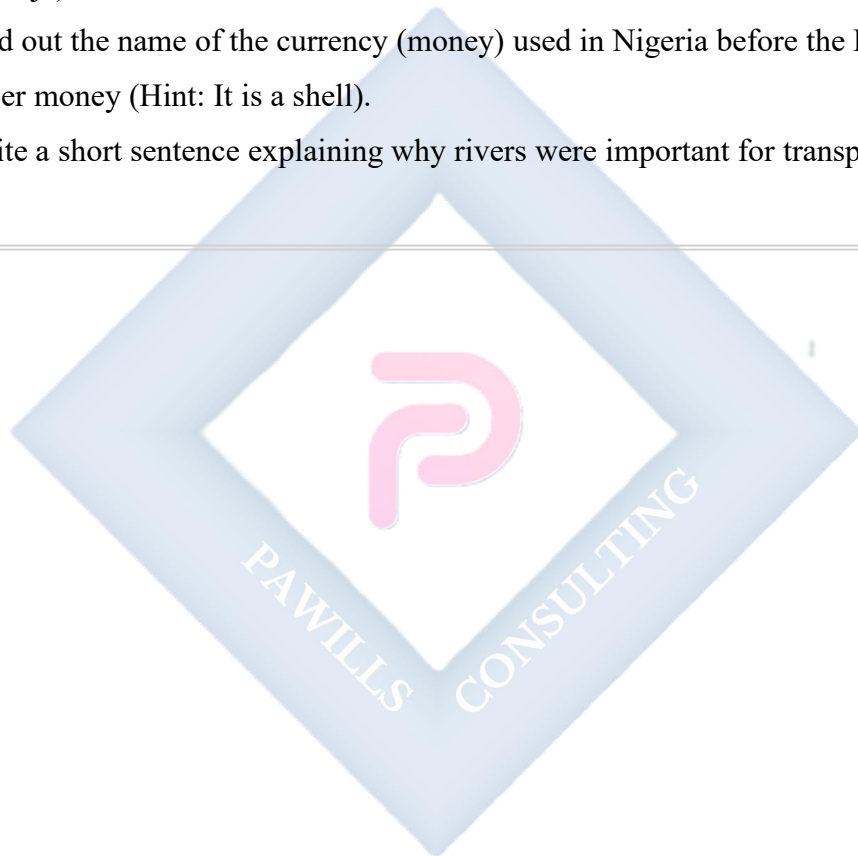
EVALUATION

1. What was the main river the British explorers were looking for?
2. In which direction did Mungo Park say the River Niger flows?

3. Where did Mungo Park die?
4. Who were the two brothers that discovered the mouth of the River Niger?
5. Into which ocean does the River Niger flow?
6. Mention one result of the British exploration.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw the River Niger and River Benue meeting in a 'Y' shape. Label the confluence (Lokoja).
 2. Find out the name of the currency (money) used in Nigeria before the British brought paper money (Hint: It is a shell).
 3. Write a short sentence explaining why rivers were important for transport long ago.
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WEEK 5 & 6: MIDTERM EXAMINATION AND BREAK.

(Note: No lesson notes required for these weeks as per standard school schedule).

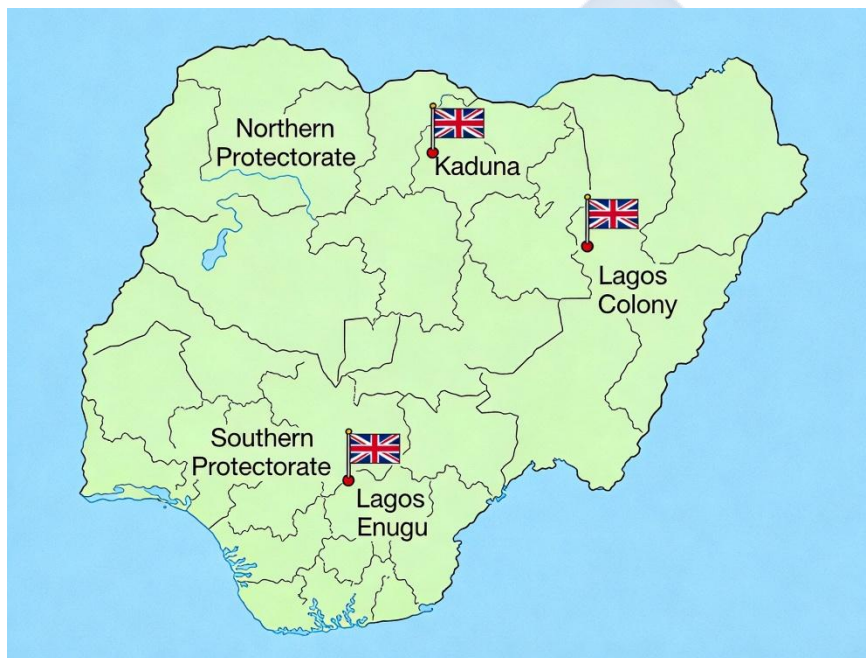


WEEK 7: COLONIAL ADMINISTRATIVE HEADQUARTERS.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a Protectorate.
2. List the different administrative units Nigeria was divided into.
3. Identify the headquarters of these units.
4. Mention the role of Lord Lugard.

CONTENT



1. Definition of a Protectorate:

- A *Protectorate* is a territory or country that is controlled and protected by a stronger foreign country.
- During the colonial era, Britain called the different parts of Nigeria "Protectorates."
- It means Britain said, "We are in charge here and will 'protect' this area," but really, they were in control.
- Think of a big brother who takes over a smaller sibling's game and makes the rules.

2. The Administrative Divisions:

- Before Nigeria became one country, the British divided the land into three separate areas to manage them easily:
- **The Colony of Lagos:** This was the area around Lagos. It was taken over by the British first, in 1861. A Colony was under direct British rule.
- **The Protectorate of Southern Nigeria:** This covered the Igbo, Ibibio, Yoruba, and Delta areas.
- **The Protectorate of Northern Nigeria:** This covered the Hausa, Fulani, and Kanuri lands in the North.

3. Headquarters of the Units:

- Each division had a capital city (Headquarters) where the British government officers lived and worked:
- The Headquarters of the **Lagos Colony** was Lagos.
- The Headquarters of the **Southern Protectorate** was initially Calabar, and later Lagos.
- The Headquarters of the **Northern Protectorate** was Lokoja, and later Zungeru and Kaduna.

[Three Divisions] North Protectorate (HQ: Kaduna) | West <---> East || Lagos Colony | South Protectorate (HQ: Calabar/Lagos)

4. Lord Lugard and Administration:

- Lord Frederick Lugard was a British soldier and administrator. He was first the High Commissioner (Governor) of the Northern Protectorate.
- He was the most important British official in Nigeria's history because he was responsible for organizing how the British ruled the different protectorates and later joined them together.

EVALUATION

1. What is a Protectorate?
2. Which year was Lagos made a colony?
3. Name the two Protectorates in Nigeria before 1914.

4. What was the first headquarters of the Southern Protectorate?
5. Who was the first High Commissioner of the Northern Protectorate?
6. Which city was the headquarters for the Lagos Colony?

ASSIGNMENT

1. On a map of Nigeria, locate Calabar and Kaduna.
 2. Write down the name of the current capital of Nigeria.
 3. Ask your teacher or parents who the "Governor-General" represents (Hint: He represented the British King/Queen).
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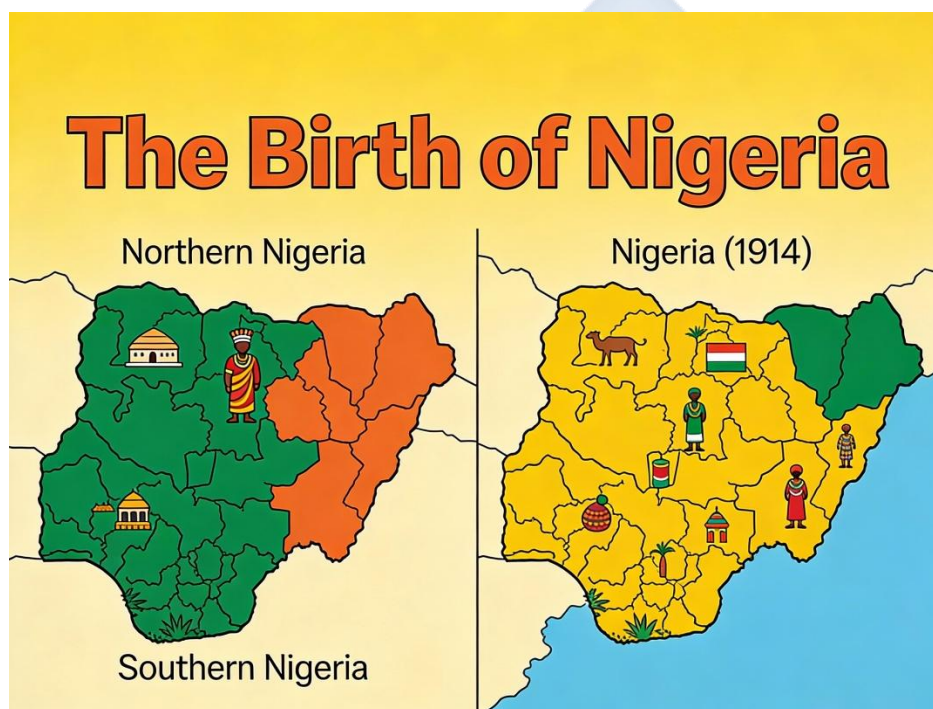


WEEK 8: THE AMALGAMATION OF NIGERIA (1914).

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define the term Amalgamation.
2. State the year Nigeria was amalgamated.
3. Identify the person responsible for the amalgamation.
4. Explain two reasons for the amalgamation.

CONTENT



1. Meaning of Amalgamation:

- *Amalgamation* means the joining of two or more things together to form one single unit.
- In Nigerian history, it refers to the joining of the different British protectorates to form one country called Nigeria.
- It is like taking two different types of dough (North and South) and kneading them together to make one loaf of bread.

2. The 1914 Amalgamation:

- On January 1st, 1914, the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria and the Protectorate of Southern Nigeria (which included Lagos) were joined together.
- Before this date, the North and South were ruled as separate countries.
- After this date, they became one country known as the Colony and Protectorate of Nigeria.
- This is why we celebrate Nigeria's birthday as 1914.

3. **Sir Frederick Lugard:**

- The man responsible for this union was Sir Frederick Lugard. After the amalgamation, he became the first Governor-General of Nigeria.
- His wife, Flora Shaw, is credited with giving Nigeria its name, coined from "Niger Area."

4. **Reasons and Effects:**

- The British amalgamated Nigeria for their own benefit, not necessarily for the Nigerians.
- **Economic Reason:** The Northern Protectorate was poor and not making money (running at a loss), while the Southern Protectorate was rich from trade (palm oil, etc.). Lugard joined them so the money from the South could be used to run the North, like using profits from one business to support another.
- **Administrative Reason:** It was easier and cheaper for the British to have one central government, one railway system, and one set of laws than to run two separate governments.
- The main effect was the birth of "One Nigeria," bringing many different people under one name and one administration.

EVALUATION

1. What does amalgamation mean?
2. In what year did the amalgamation of Nigeria take place?
3. Who amalgamated the Northern and Southern Protectorates?
4. Who gave Nigeria its name?
5. Mention one reason why the British joined the North and South.

6. What was the new title given to Lord Lugard after 1914?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Calculate how many years it has been since the amalgamation of 1914 to the current year.
2. Draw the Nigerian flag and color it correctly (Green-White-Green).
3. Write out the first stanza of the National Anthem.

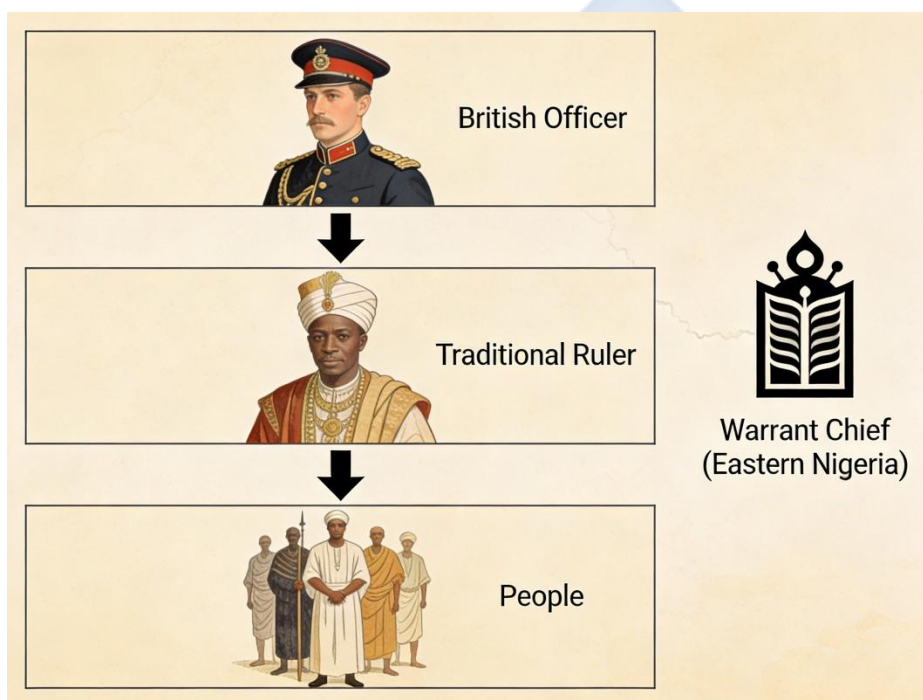


WEEK 9: COLONIAL RULE IN NIGERIA.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Explain the Indirect Rule system.
2. Define Warrant Chiefs.
3. Explain why the British used Indirect Rule.
4. Mention one example of resistance to colonial rule.

CONTENT



1. The Indirect Rule System:

- *Indirect Rule* was a system of administration used by the British to rule Nigeria.
- Instead of British officers ruling the people directly, they used the traditional rulers (Kings, Emirs, and Chiefs) to rule the people on their behalf.
- The traditional rulers took instructions from the British officers and passed them on to the people.
- It was like a prefect in school who takes orders from the headteacher and gives them to the students.

2. Reasons for Indirect Rule:

- Lord Lugard introduced this system for three main reasons:
- **Lack of Personnel:** There were very few British white officers in Nigeria, so they needed locals to help.
- **Language Barrier:** The British could not speak the local languages (Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo), but the Chiefs could.
- **Cost:** It was cheaper to use local Kings than to bring many British officers from England.

3. **Warrant Chiefs:**

- Indirect Rule worked well in the North (Emirs) and West (Obas) where there were already strong kings.
- However, in the East (Igboland), there were no powerful kings.
- The British forced the system on them by picking random people and giving them a certificate called a "Warrant" to act as chiefs.
- These were called *Warrant Chiefs*. They were often corrupt and treated the people badly because they were not chosen by the people and only cared about pleasing the British.

4. **Resistance to Colonial Rule:**

- Many Nigerians did not like Colonial rule or the Warrant Chiefs.
- They resisted by refusing to pay taxes or fighting back.
- A famous example is the Aba Women's Riot of 1929. The women in Eastern Nigeria protested against the Warrant Chiefs and the plan to tax women.
- They marched, sang war songs, and drove many Warrant Chiefs away. This showed the power of united people.

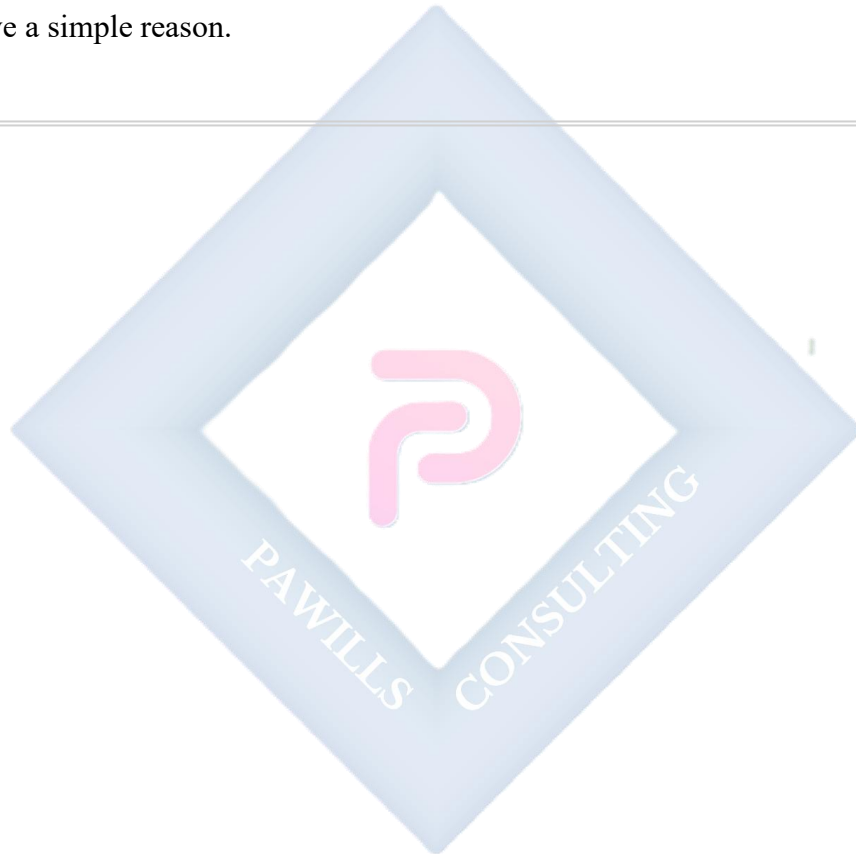
EVALUATION

1. What is Indirect Rule?
2. Mention two reasons why the British used Indirect Rule.
3. Did Indirect Rule work well in Eastern Nigeria? (Yes/No).
4. Who were the Warrant Chiefs?
5. Why did the people hate the Warrant Chiefs?

6. Mention one event where women fought against colonial rule.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Ask your parents to tell you a story about the "Aba Women's Riot" or "Ekumeku War."
 2. Write down two disadvantages of Indirect Rule for the common people (e.g., unfair chiefs, high taxes).
 3. If you were a community leader, would you allow a stranger to rule through you? Give a simple reason.
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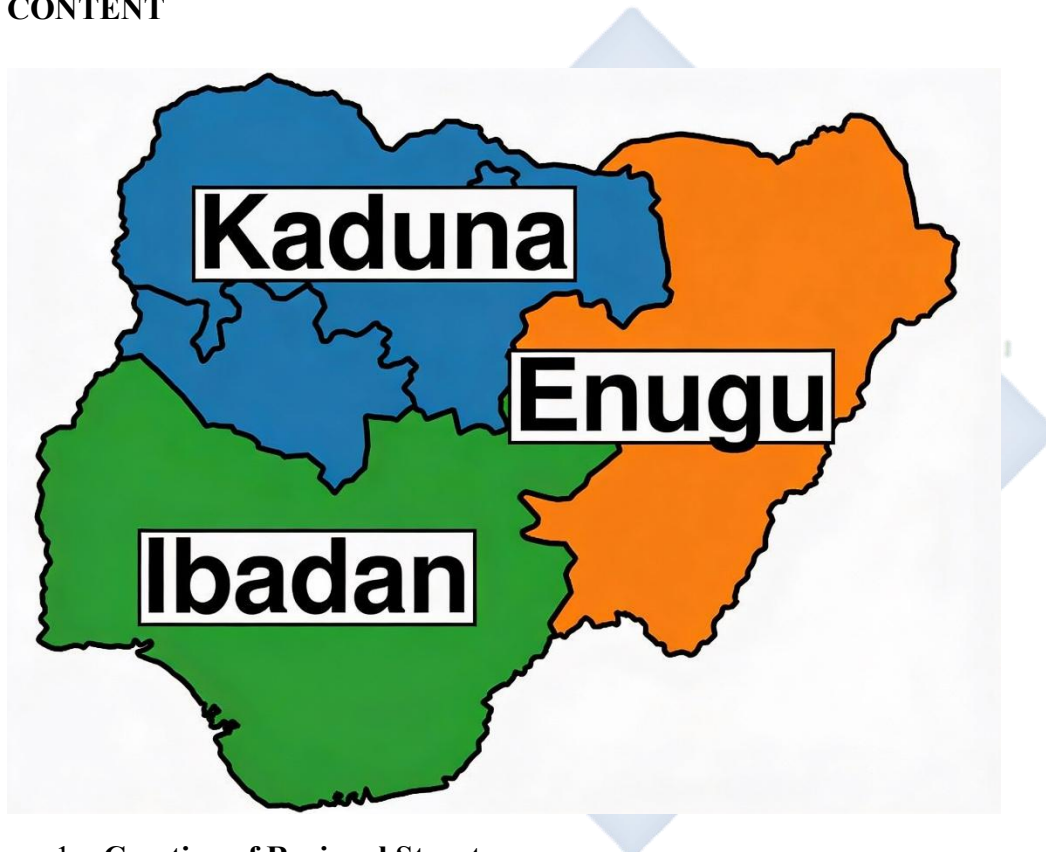


WEEK 10: THE EARLY REGIONS IN NIGERIA.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify the three early regions in Nigeria.
2. Name the capital cities of the three regions.
3. Explain why regions were created.
4. Identify the groups of people in each region.

CONTENT



1. Creation of Regional Structure:

- As Nigeria moved closer to independence, the country was divided into Regions.
- This was done by the Richards Constitution of 1946. The goal was to allow different parts of the country to develop at their own pace and manage their own local affairs while still being part of Nigeria.
- It was like giving different sections of a large school their own monitors and projects.

2. The Three Regions:

- Nigeria was divided into:

- **The Northern Region:** This was the largest region.
- **The Western Region:** Located in the southwest.
- **The Eastern Region:** Located in the southeast.

3. Capital Cities and Governments:

- Each region had its own capital city and a leader called a Premier.
- **Northern Region Capital:** Kaduna. (Main people: Hausa/Fulani).
- **Western Region Capital:** Ibadan. (Main people: Yoruba).
- **Eastern Region Capital:** Enugu. (Main people: Igbo/Ibibio/Efik).

[Three Regions Map - Text] (North) Kaduna | (West) Ibadan --- (East) Enugu

4. Importance of Regions:

- The regional system allowed the leaders of these areas to build schools, hospitals, and roads for their specific people.
- For example, the Western Region became famous for starting free primary education, while the Eastern Region focused on palm oil production and trade.
- This was the beginning of state-level development.

EVALUATION

1. How many regions was Nigeria divided into in 1946?
2. Name the capital of the Northern Region.
3. Name the capital of the Western Region.
4. Name the capital of the Eastern Region.
5. What was the title of the leader of a Region?
6. Which ethnic group was the majority in the Western Region?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Look at a current map of Nigeria. Is your state in the former North, West, or East?
Write it down.
2. Ibadan is known as the city of "red roofs." Find out one interesting thing about Enugu (Coal City) or Kaduna.

3. Write the names of the three major ethnic groups associated with the three regions.



WEEK 11: REVISION.

(Note: Use this week to review questions from Weeks 1-10 and practice for end-of-term examinations).



PRIMARY 5 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: NATIONALISM AND INDEPENDENCE MOVEMENT.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define the term Nationalism.
2. Mention the names of three major Nigerian nationalists.
3. Identify the political parties formed by the early nationalists.
4. State one goal of the nationalist movement.

CONTENT



1. Meaning of Nationalism:

- *Nationalism* is the strong love and pride a person has for their country.
- It is the desire for a country to be free from foreign rule.
- In Nigeria, nationalism meant the struggle by Nigerians to end British colonial rule so that Nigerians could govern themselves.

- People who fought for this freedom with their words and actions are called *Nationalists*.
- It is like the feeling you have for your family name and wanting your family to be independent.

2. **Early Nationalist Leaders:**

- Several brave Nigerians led the fight for independence. They used newspapers, speeches, and protests instead of guns.
- **Herbert Macaulay:** He is often called the "Father of Nigerian Nationalism." He formed the first political party and used journalism to fight.
- **Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe (Zik of Africa):** He was a journalist and a great speaker who encouraged Nigerians to unite against the British. He owned newspapers.
- **Chief Obafemi Awolowo:** He was a strong leader from the Western Region who focused on federalism and education. He started free primary education in the West.
- **Sir Ahmadu Bello (Sardauna of Sokoto):** He was a key leader from the Northern Region who fought for the rights of the North and its development.

3. **Political Parties:**

- To organize the people, these leaders formed groups called political parties, just like school clubs with different goals.
- **NCNC (National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons):** Led by Herbert Macaulay and later Nnamdi Azikiwe.
- **AG (Action Group):** Led by Chief Obafemi Awolowo.
- **NPC (Northern People's Congress):** Led by Sir Ahmadu Bello.

4. **Goals of the Nationalist Movement:**

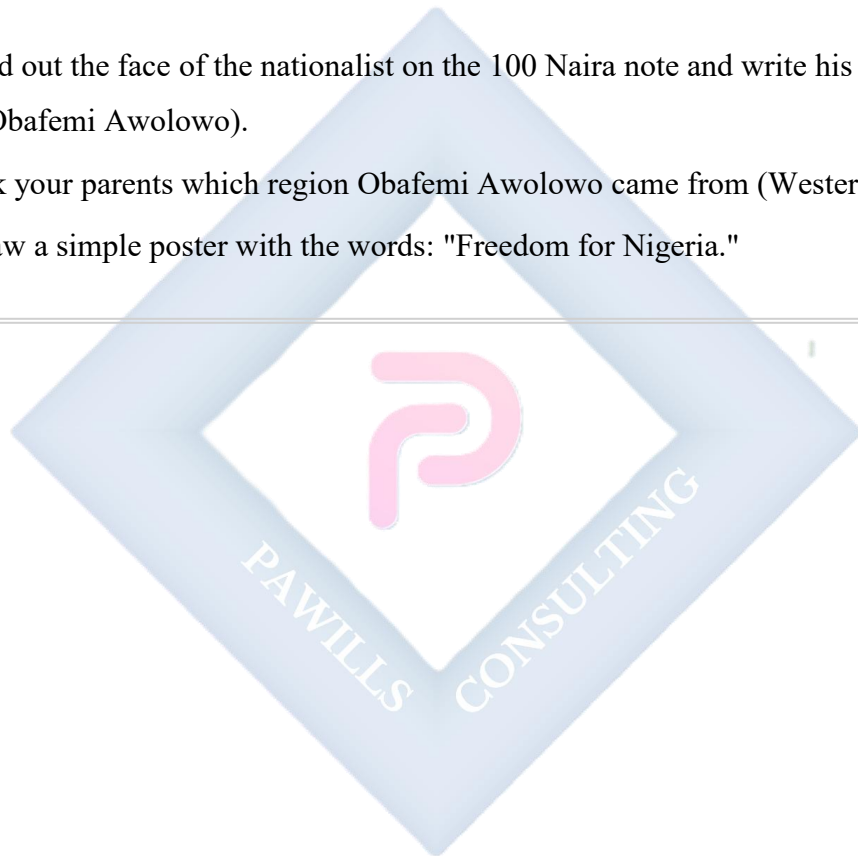
- The main goal was to stop the British from ruling Nigeria.
- They wanted Nigerians to vote for their own leaders, make their own laws, and control the money and resources of the land.
- Their slogan could have been "Nigeria for Nigerians!"

EVALUATION

- What is Nationalism?
- Who is known as the "Father of Nigerian Nationalism"?
- List two other nationalists apart from Herbert Macaulay.
- Which political party was led by Sir Ahmadu Bello?
- What was the main goal of the nationalists?
- Which tool did nationalists use to fight (Guns or Speeches)?

ASSIGNMENT

- Find out the face of the nationalist on the 100 Naira note and write his name (Hint: It is Obafemi Awolowo).
- Ask your parents which region Obafemi Awolowo came from (Western Region).
- Draw a simple poster with the words: "Freedom for Nigeria."



WEEK 2: THE ROAD TO INDEPENDENCE.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Explain what a Constitutional Conference is.
2. Mention the importance of the 1959 elections.
3. State the date Nigeria gained independence.
4. Describe the mood of Nigerians on Independence Day.

CONTENT



1. Constitutional Conferences:

- Before the British left, Nigerian leaders and British officials held several meetings called "Constitutional Conferences."
- These meetings took place in London and Lagos. The purpose was to agree on the "Rule Book" (Constitution) that would guide Nigeria.
- They discussed how power would be shared between the North, West, and East.
- It was like a family meeting to decide the new house rules before the parents (British) moved out.

2. The 1959 Elections:

- In 1959, a very important general election was held. This was to choose the leaders who would take over from the British.
- Different parties campaigned and people voted. No single party won all the votes, so they had to work together to form a government.
- This election was like a practice test before the final exam of independence.

3. **Self-Governance:**

- Before full independence, the regions were allowed to practice ruling themselves.
- The West and East became self-governing in 1957, and the North became self-governing in 1959. This was like a practice run before the British finally left, letting Nigerians drive the car with the British instructor still watching.

4. **October 1st, 1960 (Independence Day):**

- On October 1, 1960, the British flag (Union Jack) was lowered, and the Nigerian Green-White-Green flag was raised for the first time.
- This marked the end of colonial rule. Nigeria became a sovereign state (own boss).
- There were fireworks, dancing, and great joy all over the country because Nigerians were finally free. People shouted "Uhuru!" which means freedom.

EVALUATION

- What is a Constitutional Conference?
- Where were some of these conferences held?
- What happened in the year 1959?
- What is the exact date of Nigeria's independence?
- Which flag was lowered on Independence Day?
- Which flag was raised on Independence Day?

ASSIGNMENT

- Ask your grandparents or an older person what they did on October 1st, 1960 (or what they heard about it).
- Write down the current age of Nigeria (Current Year minus 1960).

- Draw the British Flag (Union Jack) next to the Nigerian Flag in your book.
-



WEEK 3: NIGERIA AS AN INDEPENDENT NATION.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify the first Prime Minister of Nigeria.
2. Identify the first Governor-General of independent Nigeria.
3. Describe the Nigerian flag and its meaning.
4. Mention the title of the Nigerian National Anthem.

CONTENT

Week 3 – Nigeria as an Independent Nation

Green = Agriculture

White = Peace

Symbolism of Nigerian Flag Colors

The Designer of the Nigerian Flag

Taiwo Akinkumi

1. The First Government (1960):

- When Nigeria became independent in 1960, we operated a Parliamentary System of government (like Britain).
- In this system, the head of government is different from the head of state.
- Think of a company: The Prime Minister is the Managing Director (runs things daily), and the Governor-General was like the Chairman of the board (ceremonial head).
- **Prime Minister:** Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa. He was the head of the government and did the day-to-day work of running the country.

- **Governor-General:** Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe. He represented the Queen of England (who was still technically the head) and performed ceremonial duties like giving speeches and receiving visitors.

2. **Independence Challenges:**

- Although Nigeria was free, there were challenges. The different regions (North, West, East) often disagreed on how to share power and money.
- There was also a need to build more schools, roads, and hospitals for the people without British help.
- It was like a new driver learning to navigate rough roads alone.

3. **The Nigerian Flag:**

- The flag was designed by Mr. Taiwo Akinkunmi, who was a student when he submitted the winning design.
- It has two colors: Green and White.
- **Green:** stands for agriculture and the rich natural wealth of Nigeria (our forests and farms).
- **White:** stands for peace and unity, wishing for Nigerians to live together in harmony.

4. **The National Anthem:**

- At independence, Nigeria adopted a new National Anthem "Nigeria, We Hail Thee."
- It was written by a British lady, Lillian Jean Williams.
- It reminded Nigerians that though they belong to different tribes, they must stand as brothers and sisters.
- The first line is: "Nigeria, we hail thee, Our own dear native land."

EVALUATION

1. Who was the first Prime Minister of Nigeria?
2. Who was the first Governor-General of Nigeria?
3. Who designed the Nigerian flag?
4. What does the green color on the flag represent?
5. What does the white color on the flag represent?

6. What was the title of the first National Anthem?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Recite the **first stanza** of the current National Anthem ("Arise, O Compatriots...") to your parents.
2. Write down the name of the man who designed the Nigerian flag (Taiwo Akinkunmi).
3. Draw the Nigerian Coat of Arms (you can trace it if it is difficult).

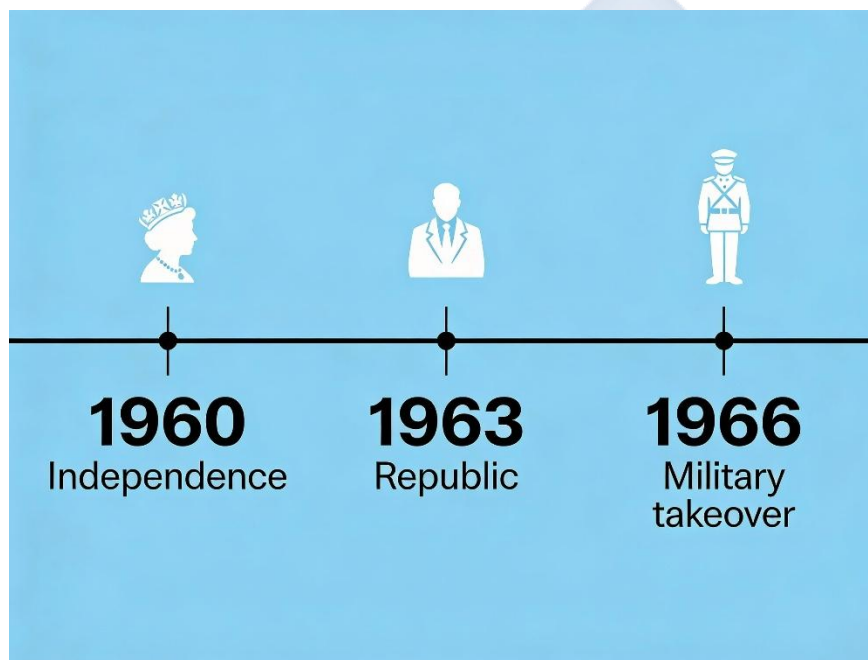


WEEK 4: POLITICAL DEVELOPMENTS IN NIGERIA I (FIRST REPUBLIC).

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define the First Republic.
2. Explain the change that happened in 1963.
3. Distinguish between a Governor-General and a President.
4. Mention one major problem of the First Republic.

CONTENT



1. The First Republic (1963-1966):

- From 1960 to 1963, Nigeria was independent, but the Queen of England was still our Head of State.
- On October 1st, 1963, Nigeria became a Republic. This means we cut all political ties with the British Crown.
- We no longer had a Governor-General representing the Queen; instead, we had our own President.
- So, 1960 was Independence, 1963 was becoming a full Republic.

2. Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe as President:

- In 1963, Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe changed from being Governor-General to becoming the first President of Nigeria (Head of State).
- Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa remained the Prime Minister (Head of Government).
- Now, both top leaders were Nigerians with no link to Britain.

3. **Regional Politics:**

- During the First Republic, the regions (North, West, East, and later Mid-West) were very powerful.
- They had their own constitutions and operated almost like separate countries.
- This caused competition and jealousy between the regions over resources and power.

4. **Political Crises:**

- There was a lot of trouble during this period.
- Politicians fought over election results, accusing each other of cheating.
- There was violence in the Western Region (called "Operation Wetie") where houses and cars were burnt with petrol.
- There was corruption and distrust among the leaders.
- These problems made the military angry and led to the end of the First Republic.

EVALUATION

1. In what year did Nigeria become a Republic?
2. Who was the first President of Nigeria?
3. What is the difference between 1960 and 1963 in Nigerian history?
4. True or False: The Queen of England was still Head of State in 1964.
5. Mention one bad thing that happened during the First Republic.
6. Which region had a crisis known as "Operation Wetie"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write down the full date (Day, Month, Year) when Nigeria became a Republic.
2. Find out the name of the Premier of the Western Region during the crisis (Ask your parents - Chief S.L. Akintola).

3. Write one sentence explaining why fighting is bad for a country.



WEEK 5 & 6: MIDTERM EXAMINATION AND BREAK.

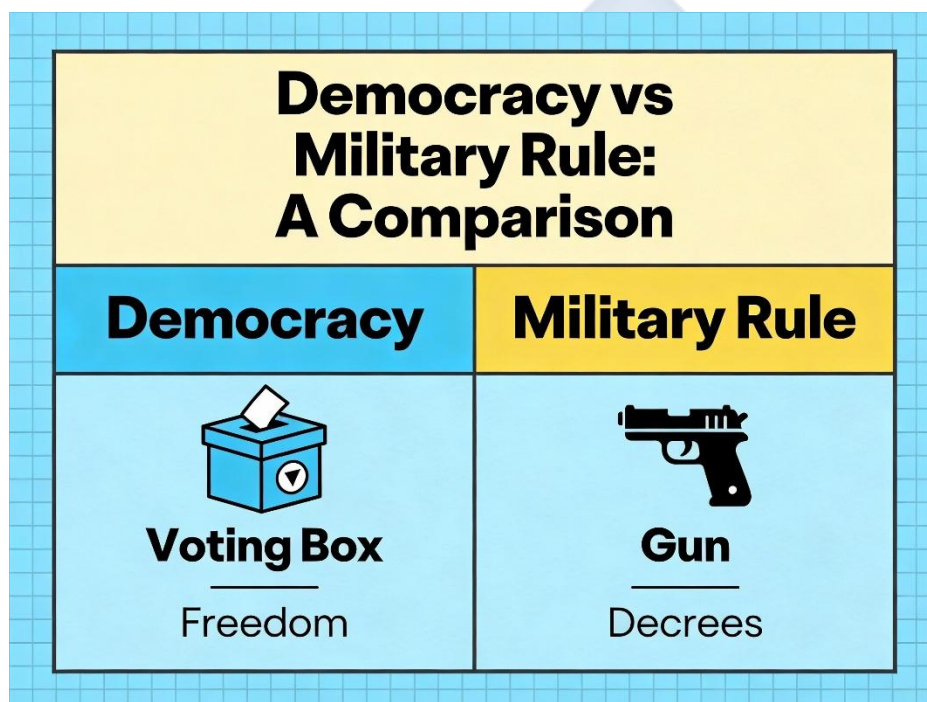


WEEK 7: POLITICAL DEVELOPMENTS IN NIGERIA II (MILITARY RULE).

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a Military Coup.
2. State when the first military coup took place.
3. Mention the name of the first Military Head of State.
4. List two effects of military rule.

CONTENT



1. Meaning of Military Coup:

- A *military coup* (or *coup d'état*) is when soldiers use force and guns to remove a democratically elected government and take power for themselves.
- When this happens, the Constitution is suspended (put aside), and the soldiers rule by decrees (forceful laws).
- It is like a school bully taking over the class from the teacher.

2. The First Military Coup (January 1966):

- On January 15, 1966, a group of young army majors led a coup.

- They killed many leaders, including the Prime Minister (Tafawa Balewa) and Premiers like Ahmadu Bello and Samuel Akintola.
- This brought an end to the First Republic. It was a very sad and shocking Saturday morning for Nigeria.

3. **Military Administrators:**

- Major General J.T.U. Aguiyi-Ironsi became the first Military Head of State.
- After him, there were many other military rulers like General Yakubu Gowon, General Murtala Muhammed, and General Olusegun Obasanjo.
- Military rulers are not elected by the people; they seize power by force.

4. **Effects of Military Rule:**

- **Suspension of Constitution:** Laws were made by the soldiers without asking the people. Your rights could be taken away easily.
- **Violence:** Coups were often bloody and people were killed. Fear was everywhere.
- **Discipline:** Sometimes, the military tried to enforce discipline (e.g., War Against Indiscipline - WAI), making people queue properly.
- **Infrastructure:** Some military governments built roads, bridges, and created new states, which helped development.

EVALUATION

1. What is a military coup?
2. When did the first military coup happen in Nigeria?
3. Who was the first Military Head of State?
4. What happens to the Constitution during military rule?
5. Are military rulers elected by voting? (Yes/No).
6. Mention one effect of military rule.

ASSIGNMENT

1. List the names of three military Heads of State in Nigeria.
2. Ask your parents if they prefer Military Rule or Democracy and write down their answer.

3. Draw a picture of a soldier's cap or boot.



WEEK 8: THE NIGERIAN CIVIL WAR (1967-1970).

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. State the duration of the Nigerian Civil War.
2. Identify the leader of the Biafran side.
3. Mention two causes of the war.
4. Explain the slogan "No Victor, No Vanquished."

CONTENT



1. Causes of the Civil War:

- The Nigerian Civil War, also known as the Biafran War, happened because of deep anger and distrust between the tribes, especially after the killings of 1966. The Eastern Region, led by the Igbo people, felt unsafe in Nigeria and wanted to leave to form their own country.
- It was like a big family argument that turned into a serious fight.

2. Biafra Secession:

- On May 30, 1967, Lt. Col. Odumegwu Ojukwu declared the Eastern Region an independent country called "The Republic of Biafra."

- The Nigerian government, led by General Yakubu Gowon, did not accept this. They wanted Nigeria to remain one.
- This disagreement led to war. *Secession* means to break away.

3. The War (1967-1970):

- The fighting started in July 1967 and lasted for 30 months (2 and a half years).
- It was a very sad time. Many people died from bullets, bombs, and starvation (hunger) because food could not get into the East.
- Children suffered greatly.

4. End of the War and Reconciliation:

- The war ended in January 1970 when Biafra surrendered. General Yakubu Gowon declared that there was "No Victor, No Vanquished" (meaning no one won and no one lost).
- He introduced the "3 Rs" program: **Reconciliation** (making peace), **Rehabilitation** (helping people heal), and **Reconstruction** (rebuilding the broken places), to bring the Igbos back into Nigeria and rebuild the country.

EVALUATION

- How long did the Nigerian Civil War last?
- Who was the leader of the Biafran side?
- Who was the Head of State of Nigeria during the war?
- What was the name of the country the Eastern Region tried to create?
- Mention one bad thing that happens during a war.
- What did General Gowon say at the end of the war?

ASSIGNMENT

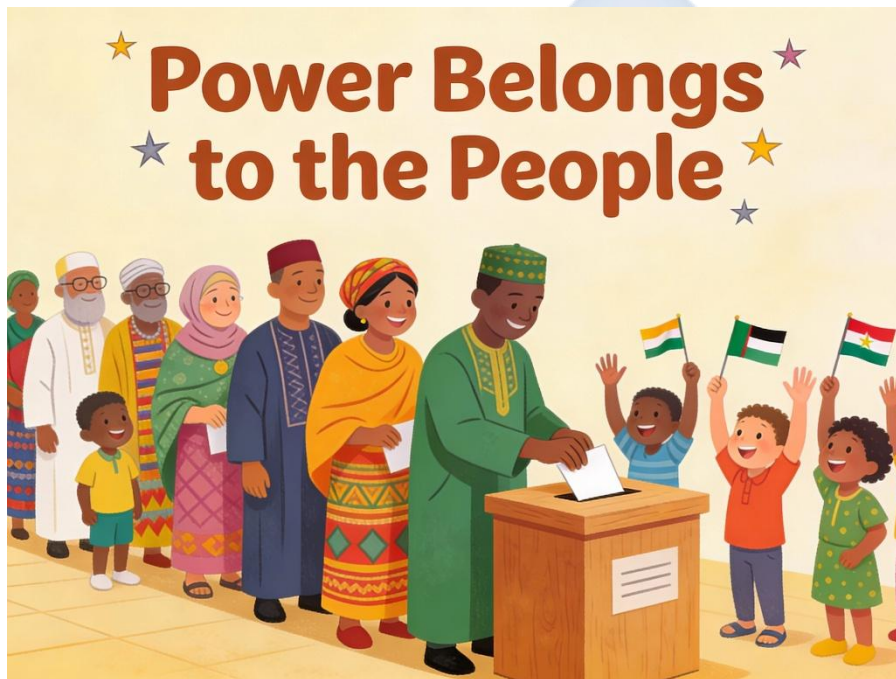
- Write down the year the Civil War started and the year it ended.
- Find out what the "3 Rs" stand for.
- Write a short prayer or wish for peace in Nigeria.

WEEK 9: RETURN TO DEMOCRACY.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define Democracy.
2. Identify the President of the Second Republic.
3. Mention the date of the return to democracy (Fourth Republic).
4. State two benefits of democracy.

CONTENT



1. Meaning of Democracy:

- *Democracy* is a government of the people, by the people, and for the people.
- In a democracy, citizens choose their leaders by voting in an election.
- It is different from military rule because people have freedom of speech and rights.
- It is like choosing your class captain by voting, not by force.

2. The Second Republic (1979-1983):

- After many years of military rule, General Obasanjo handed over power to a civilian (non-soldier) leader in 1979. Alhaji Shehu Shagari was elected as the first Executive President of Nigeria.

- This period is called the Second Republic. However, the military came back in 1983 through another coup.
- So, democracy was still young and unstable.

3. **The Fourth Republic (1999-Present):**

- After another long period of military rule, Nigeria finally returned to democracy on May 29, 1999. Chief Olusegun Obasanjo (now a civilian) was elected President.
- Since then, Nigeria has remained a democratic country. May 29 is now celebrated as Democracy Day.

4. **Benefits of Democracy:**

- **Voting:** We can choose who rules us. Our vote is our voice.
- **Freedom:** We can speak and write freely without fear (Freedom of Speech and Press).
- **Rule of Law:** Everyone must obey the law, even the President. No one is above the law.

EVALUATION

1. What is democracy?
2. Who was the President during the Second Republic?
3. What date is celebrated as "Democracy Day" for the 1999 handover?
4. Who became President in 1999?
5. Mention one benefit of democracy.
6. Which is better: being forced to do something or choosing to do it?

ASSIGNMENT

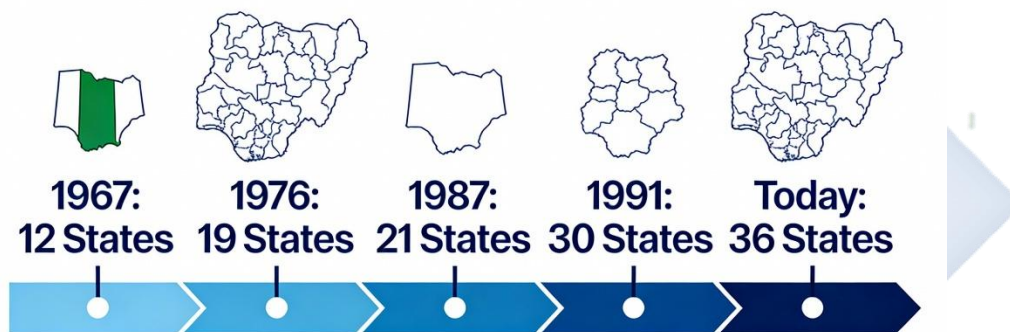
1. Find out the name of the current President of Nigeria.
2. Find out the name of the current Governor of your State.
3. Draw a ballot box (the box used for voting).

WEEK 10: STATES CREATION IN NIGERIA I.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Explain why states were created.
2. Mention the year the first 12 states were created.
3. Identify the Head of State who created the first states.
4. State the current number of states in Nigeria.

CONTENT



1. Reasons for Creating States:

- Originally, Nigeria had only Regions (North, West, East, Mid-West). States were created to:
- Bring the government closer to the people. It's easier to reach a state office than a far-away regional capital.
- Make sure development (roads, water, electricity) reaches everywhere, not just the big cities.

- Stop one region from being too powerful and threatening the unity of the country.
- Many small pieces are easier to manage than a few big ones.

2. **The 12 States (1967):**

- Just before the Civil War in 1967, General Yakubu Gowon broke the 4 regions into 12 States.
- This was a very clever move to weaken the secession attempt by Biafra and unite other minorities.
- By creating states like Rivers and South-Eastern State, he gave minority groups a voice and reduced the power of the big regions.

3. **Increase to 19 and 21 States:**

- In 1976, General Murtala Muhammed created more states, bringing the total to 19. He wanted more even development.
- In 1987, General Ibrahim Babangida created 2 more, making it 21 states.
- Over time, more states were added until we reached the 36 states we have today.
- It was like splitting a large piece of land into smaller plots for more families.

4. **Benefits:**

- Because of state creation, many towns that were essentially villages became state capitals.
- This brought development like airports, universities, and good roads to those towns.
- For example, Owerri, Uyo, and Makurdi grew because they became state capitals.

EVALUATION

1. Why were states created in Nigeria? (Mention one reason).
2. Who created the first 12 states?
3. In what year were the first 12 states created?
4. How many states did General Murtala Muhammed create?
5. How many states do we have in Nigeria today?
6. Is your school in a state or a region?

ASSIGNMENT

1. List 5 states in Nigeria and their capitals.
 2. Write down the name of the state where your school is located.
 3. Draw a map of your state (roughly) and put a dot where the capital is.
-



WEEK 11: REVISION.

(Review all topics from Weeks 1-10. Focus on dates, names of leaders, and the difference between military and democratic rule.)



PRIMARY 5 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: STATES CREATION IN NIGERIA II.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Mention the Head of State who created 30 states and the one who created 36 states.
2. State the current number of states in Nigeria.
3. List five states and their capitals.
4. Explain the meaning of a Local Government Area.

CONTENT



1. Creation of 30 and 36 States:

- We learned last term that Nigeria started with 12 states.

- Over time, more states were added to bring development closer to the people.
- **30 States (1991):** General Ibrahim Babangida increased the number of states from 21 to 30. More states meant more capitals and more development projects.
- **36 States (1996):** General Sani Abacha increased the number of states from 30 to 36. This is the number we have today. The newest states are Bayelsa, Ebonyi, Ekiti, Gombe, Nasarawa, and Zamfara.

2. **Current States and Capitals:**

- Nigeria is a big family made up of 36 states and one Federal Capital Territory (Abuja).
- Every state has a capital city where the Governor lives and works.
- Examples include:
- Lagos State -- Ikeja
- Kano State -- Kano City
- Rivers State -- Port Harcourt
- Enugu State -- Enugu City
- Adamawa State -- Yola

3. **Memorizing States:**

- To remember the states, we can group them by their location (North, South, East, West).
- It is important for every pupil to know their own state and its capital, as well as the states of their friends.
- You can learn them like the lyrics to a song!

4. **Local Government Creation:**

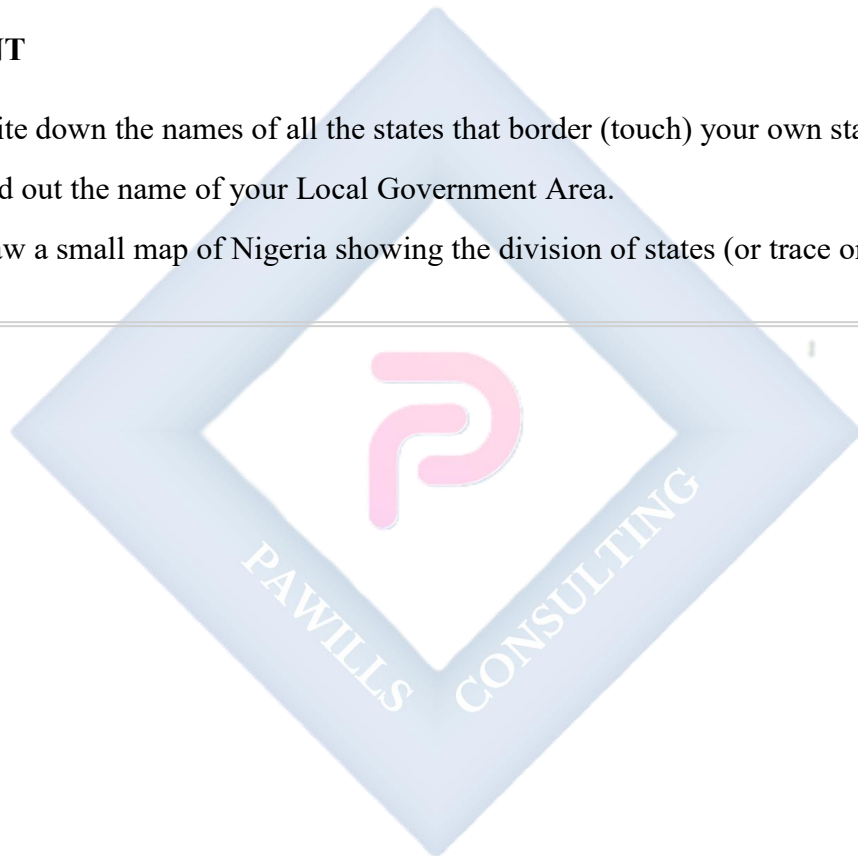
- Just as the country is divided into states, every state is divided into smaller parts called Local Government Areas (LGAs).
- There are **774** Local Government Areas in Nigeria.
- The Local Government is the closest government to the common people in the villages and towns.
- They handle things like primary schools, health centers, and local roads.

EVALUATION

1. How many states are there in Nigeria today?
2. Which General created the 36 states?
3. Mention the capital of Lagos State.
4. Mention the capital of Kano State.
5. How many Local Government Areas are there in Nigeria?
6. What is the capital of your own state?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write down the names of all the states that border (touch) your own state.
2. Find out the name of your Local Government Area.
3. Draw a small map of Nigeria showing the division of states (or trace one).

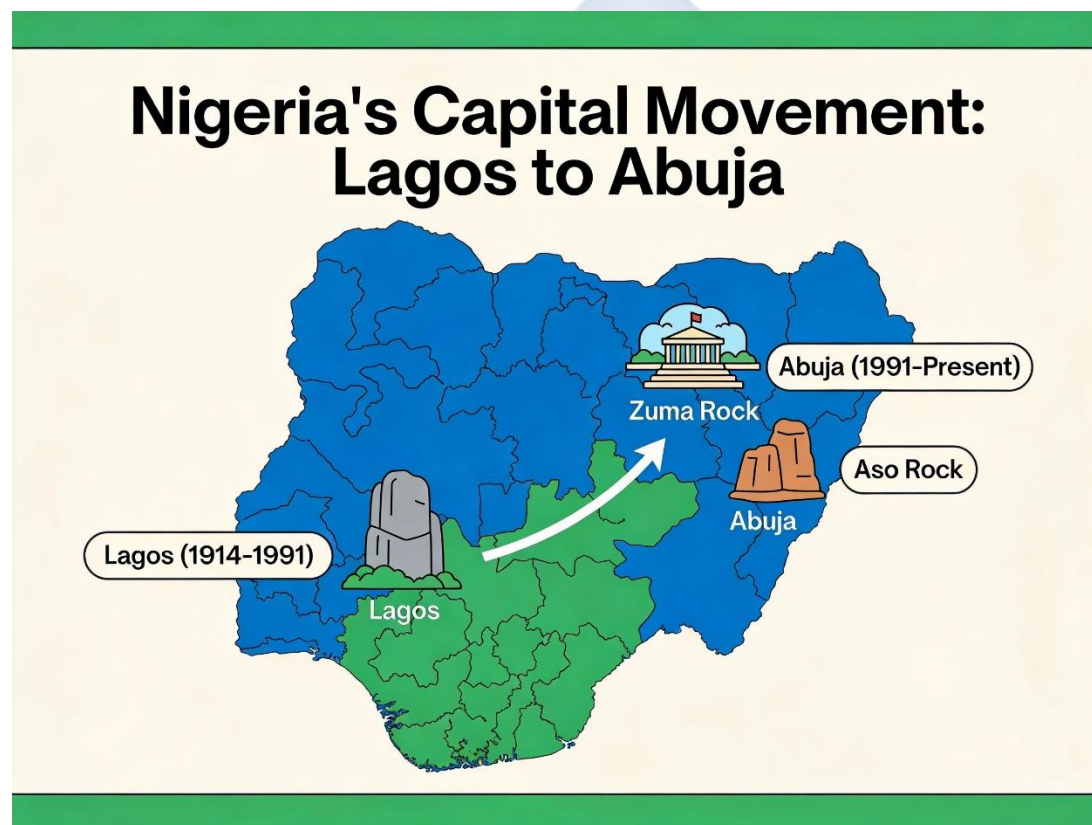


WEEK 2: FEDERAL CAPITAL IN NIGERIA.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify the former Federal Capital of Nigeria.
2. Mention the current Federal Capital of Nigeria.
3. State two reasons why the capital was moved.
4. Identify the year the capital was officially moved to Abuja.

CONTENT



1. Lagos as the First Capital (1914--1991):

- From the time Nigeria was amalgamated in 1914 until 1991, Lagos was the capital city of Nigeria.
- It was the place where the Head of State lived and where all the major government offices were located.
- Lagos is a bustling port city on the coast.

2. Reasons for Moving the Capital:

- The government decided to move the capital away from Lagos for several reasons:
- **Congestion:** Lagos was too crowded with people and cars (traffic). There was no space to build new government offices. It was like an overfull classroom.
- **Location:** Lagos is on the edge of the country (near the ocean). The government wanted a capital in the **center** of Nigeria so it would be equal distance for everyone coming from the North, South, East, or West. This promotes a sense of belonging for all.
- **Security:** A central location is safer and harder for enemies to attack from the sea.

3. Selection and Development of Abuja:

- A panel led by Justice Akinola Aguda chose Abuja as the new location because it is right in the middle of Nigeria.
- It was a "neutral" land, meaning it did not belong to any of the three major ethnic groups (Hausa, Igbo, Yoruba), making it a symbol of unity.
- They built a modern city from scratch.

4. Abuja as FCT (Federal Capital Territory):

- Construction started in the 1980s, and on December 12, 1991, the capital was officially moved from Lagos to Abuja by General Ibrahim Babangida.
- Today, the President lives in Aso Rock Villa in Abuja. The FCT is not a state; it is directly controlled by the Federal Government.

EVALUATION

1. Which city was the capital of Nigeria before Abuja?
2. Mention one reason why the capital was moved from Lagos.
3. In what year was the capital officially moved to Abuja?
4. Who lives in Aso Rock Villa?
5. Is Abuja in the North, South, or Center of Nigeria?
6. What does FCT stand for?

ASSIGNMENT

1. On a map of Nigeria, locate Lagos and Abuja. Draw a line connecting them.
 2. Write down the name of the famous rock found in or near Abuja (Hint: It is on the 100 Naira note) - Zuma Rock.
 3. Ask your parents if they have ever visited Abuja and write down one thing they like about it.
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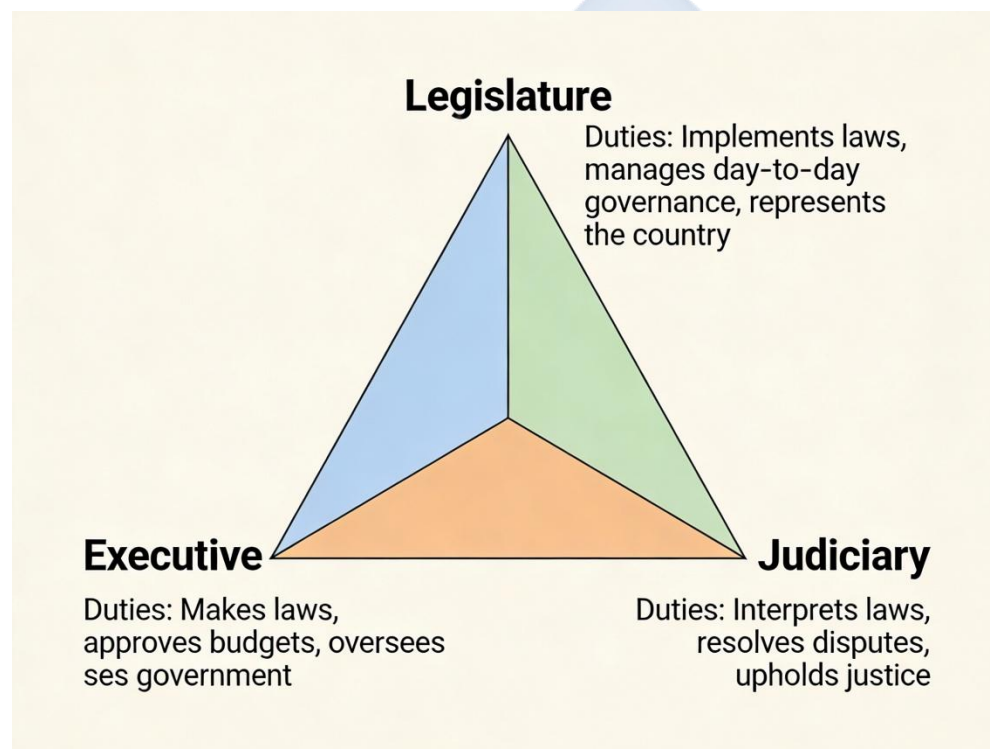


WEEK 3: THE STRUCTURE OF NIGERIAN GOVERNMENT.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Define a Federal System of Government.
2. List the three Arms of Government.
3. Explain the duty of each Arm of Government.
4. Mention the three Tiers (levels) of Government.

CONTENT



1. Federal System of Government:

- Nigeria operates a Federal System. This means power is shared. One person does not hold all the power.
- Power is shared between the central government in Abuja and the state governments.
- It is like a school where the headteacher has some power, but the class teachers also have power over their classes.

2. The Three Arms of Government:

- To make sure the country runs smoothly, the government is divided into three branches or "arms." Each arm has a special job:
- **The Legislature:** These are the lawmakers (Senators and House of Representatives). Their job is to **make the laws**. They are like the students' parliament that suggests school rules.
- **The Executive:** This includes the President, Governors, and Ministers. Their job is to **enforce (do)** the laws and run the country. They are like the headteacher and teachers who make sure school rules are followed.
- **The Judiciary:** This includes the Judges and Courts. Their job is to **interpret** the laws and punish those who break them. They are like the school disciplinary committee.

3. Separation of Powers:

- Each arm is independent. The President cannot just put someone in jail; the Judiciary must decide.
- The President cannot just make a law; the Legislature must pass it. This prevents one person from becoming a dictator.
- It's a system of checks and balances.

4. Three Tiers of Government:

- Government also exists at different levels (tiers):
- **Federal Government:** Controls the whole country (Head: President). Deals with defense, currency, foreign affairs.
- **State Government:** Controls a state (Head: Governor). Deals with schools, hospitals, roads within the state.
- **Local Government:** Controls a local area (Head: Chairman). Deals with markets, primary schools, local clinics.

EVALUATION

1. Which arm of government makes the laws?
2. Which arm of government interprets the laws and judges cases?
3. Who is the head of the Executive arm at the Federal level?

4. Mention the three tiers of government in Nigeria.
5. Why do we separate powers among the three arms?
6. Who is the head of a State Government?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a triangle. Label the three corners: Federal, State, and Local Government.
 2. Write down the name of the current Governor of your state (Executive arm).
 3. Find out who makes the laws for a Local Government (Hint: They are called Councillors).
-



WEEK 4: LOCAL GOVERNMENT SYSTEM.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify the head of a Local Government.
2. List three functions of a Local Government.
3. Explain why the Local Government is important to the "grassroots."
4. Mention who assists the Chairman.

CONTENT



1. The Local Government Chairman:

- The Local Government is the third tier of government. The head is called the Chairman.
- He or she is elected by the people living in that area.
- The Chairman is assisted by the Vice-Chairman and Supervisors (like heads of departments).

2. The Councillors:

- Just as the President has the National Assembly to make laws, the Local Government Chairman has a group of people called Councillors.

- They represent different wards (neighborhoods) and make bye-laws (local rules) for the area, like rules about sanitation or market days.

3. **Functions of Local Government:**

- The Local Government has many duties that affect our daily lives:
- **Health:** They build and run health centers and dispensaries where you get treated for malaria.
- **Education:** They are responsible for Primary Schools. Your primary school is likely under the LGA.
- **Environment:** They clean the markets and drains to prevent floods and diseases.
- **Registration:** They issue birth and death certificates. Your birth certificate was issued by an LGA.
- **Markets:** They build and maintain motor parks and markets where your parents buy food.

4. **Grassroots Development:**

- "Grassroots" means the common people in the villages and communities.
- The Local Government is important because the Federal Government in Abuja is too far away to know if a small village needs a water pump.
- The Local Government is close enough to know and solve these problems.
- They are the government you can see and touch.

EVALUATION

1. Who is the political head of a Local Government?
2. Who makes laws at the Local Government level?
3. Mention two duties of the Local Government.
4. Which level of government is responsible for Primary Schools?
5. Where do you go to get a birth certificate?
6. Why is the Local Government called "Grassroots" government?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Visit a nearby market or motor park. Find out if it is managed by the Local Government.
 2. Ask your parents to show you your birth certificate. Check if it was issued by a Local Government.
 3. Write a letter (3 sentences) to your Local Government Chairman asking him to fix a road or school in your area.
-



WEEK 5 & 6: MIDTERM EXAMINATION AND BREAK.



WEEK 7: HISTORICAL FEATURES AND SITES IN NIGERIA I.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify three historical sites in Nigeria.
2. Describe the Kano City Walls.
3. Explain the importance of the National War Museum.
4. Define preservation.

CONTENT



1. Introduction to Historical Sites:

- Nigeria has many old places that tell the story of our past.
- These places are preserved so that children like you can see them today. They are like open-air history books.

2. Kano City Walls and Gidan Rumfa:

- **Kano City Walls:** These are ancient defensive walls built hundreds of years ago to protect the people of Kano from invaders. They were made of baked clay/mud and were very thick and high. Some parts are still standing today.
- **Gidan Rumfa:** This is the palace of the Emir of Kano. It was built over 500 years ago and is a beautiful example of Hausa architecture with intricate designs and courtyards.

3. **Sukur Cultural Landscape:**

- Located in Adamawa State, this is a UNESCO World Heritage site.
- It is an ancient settlement on a hill with terraced fields (farming on steps cut into the hill) and a palace for the Hidi (Chief).
- It shows how people lived and farmed long ago in a very clever way to prevent soil erosion.

4. **National War Museum, Umuahia:**

- This museum is in Abia State. It contains weapons, ships, and airplanes used during the Nigerian Civil War.
- It is important because it reminds us of the war and teaches us the value of peace.
- We learn from the past so we don't make the same mistakes.

5. **Importance of Preservation:**

- We must protect (preserve) these sites so they are not destroyed.
- If they are destroyed, we will lose our history and identity.
- *Preservation* means keeping something safe from harm or decay for the future.

EVALUATION

1. Where are the ancient City Walls located?
2. What is Gidan Rumfa?
3. In which state is the Sukur Cultural Landscape found?
4. What can be found in the National War Museum?
5. Why should we protect old buildings and sites?
6. Mention one material used to build the Kano Walls.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a picture of a traditional mud wall or castle.
 2. Ask your parents if they have visited any museum in Nigeria. Write the name.
 3. Write one sentence on why we should keep old things safe.
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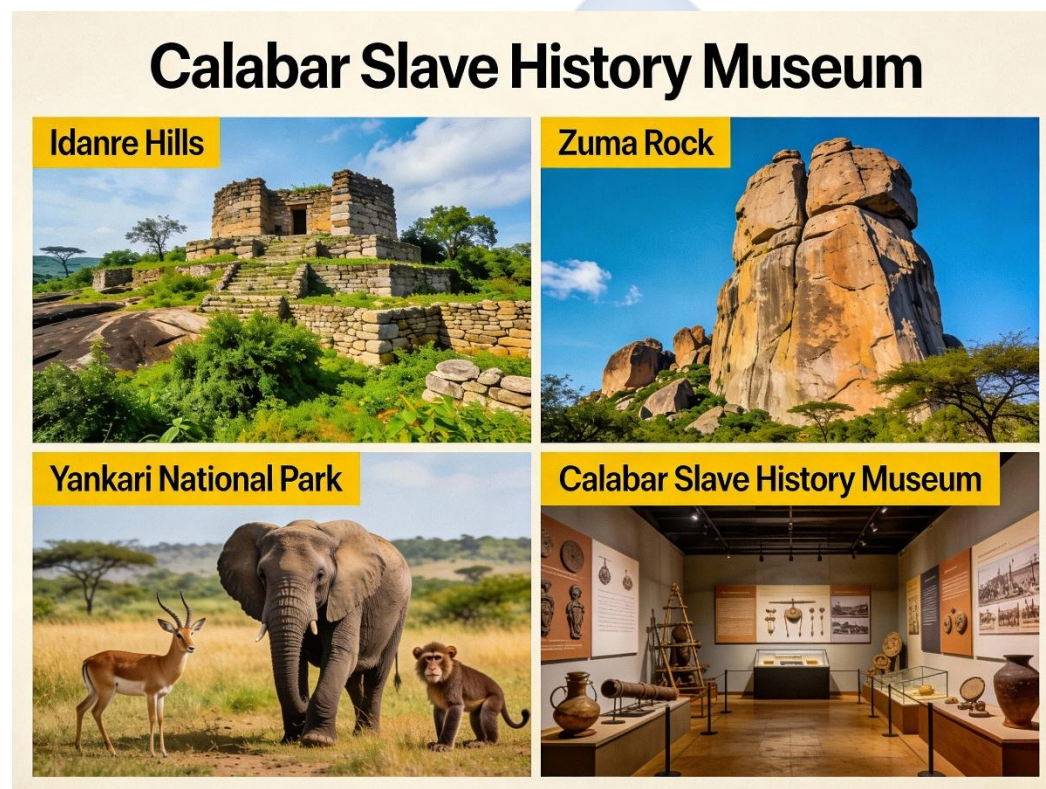


WEEK 8: HISTORICAL FEATURES AND SITES IN NIGERIA II.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Locate Idanre Hills and Zuma Rock.
2. Describe the Yankari National Park.
3. Explain the purpose of the Calabar Slave History Museum.
4. Define tourism.

CONTENT



1. Idanre Hills (Ondo State):

- These are massive, steep hills that surround the town of Idanre.
- Long ago, the people lived on top of the hills to be safe from wars.
- You have to climb about 660 steps to get to the top!
- It is a great place for adventure and has an old courthouse and palace on the hill.

2. Zuma Rock (Niger State):

- Zuma Rock is a huge rock located near Abuja. It is often called the "Gateway to Abuja."
- It is very famous because it has a natural feature that looks like a human face on it.
- It is also on the 100 Naira note. It stands alone like a giant guardian.

3. **Yankari National Park (Bauchi State):**

- This is a large wildlife park. It has a warm spring (Wikki Warm Spring) where people can swim all year round because the water is always warm.
- It also has animals like elephants, baboons, and antelopes living freely in the wild.
- It is Nigeria's most famous game reserve.

4. **Calabar Slave History Museum (Cross River State):**

- This museum is in Calabar. It shows the history of the slave trade.
- Calabar was a major port where slaves were shipped out of Nigeria.
- The museum teaches us about the suffering of our ancestors so we remember the evils of slavery and value freedom and human dignity.

5. **Tourism and Heritage:**

- *Tourism* means traveling to visit interesting places for fun or learning.
- These sites bring money to Nigeria because people from other countries pay to visit them.
- Tourism creates jobs for guides, hotel workers, and drivers.

EVALUATION

1. In which state are the Idanre Hills located?
2. Which rock has a "human face" and is near Abuja?
3. What animals can you see at Yankari National Park?
4. What does the Calabar Museum teach us about?
5. What is tourism?
6. Which currency note has the picture of Zuma Rock?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Check a 100 Naira note and locate Zuma Rock.
 2. Mention one animal you would like to see at Yankari Games Reserve.
 3. If a tourist came to your town, where would you take them to visit?
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WEEK 9: NIGERIAN SYMBOLS AND IDENTITY.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify four national symbols of Nigeria.
2. Explain the meaning of the Coat of Arms features.
3. Recite the National Pledge.
4. Recognize the Nigerian currency.

CONTENT



1. The National Symbols:

- National symbols are special objects that represent Nigeria. When we see them, we know they belong to our country.
- They make us feel proud and united.
- The National Flag: (Green-White-Green).
- The National Anthem: Our song of loyalty.
- The National Pledge: A promise to be faithful to Nigeria.
- The Naira and Kobo: Our money.

2. The Coat of Arms:

- This is the official seal of authority. It is used on government documents and buildings. It has several parts with meanings:
- **Black Shield:** Represents the fertile soil of Nigeria.
- **Two White Horses:** Represent dignity and pride.
- **Red Eagle:** Represents strength.
- **The "Y" Shape (Silver Wavy Band):** Represents the River Niger and River Benue flowing together in Lokoja.
- **Flowers (Costus Spectabilis):** Represent the beauty of Nigeria.
- **Motto:** Unity and Faith, Peace and Progress. This is our national goal.

3. The National Pledge:

- The pledge is a promise every Nigerian makes to serve the country.
- It encourages us to be faithful, loyal, and honest. We recite it in schools every morning.
- It begins: "I pledge to Nigeria my country, to be faithful, loyal and honest..."

4. Nigerian Currency:

- The official currency is the Naira (₦) and Kobo (k).
- We have notes (5, 10, 20, 50, 100, 200, 500, 1000) and coins.
- The notes have pictures of our heroes and important places, like Zuma Rock (₦100) and the National Coat of Arms.

EVALUATION

1. Mention three national symbols.
2. What do the two white horses on the Coat of Arms represent?
3. What does the black shield represent?
4. What is the motto of Nigeria written on the Coat of Arms?
5. Recite the first line of the National Pledge.
6. What is the symbol for Naira?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw the Nigerian Coat of Arms in your notebook (you can trace it).
 2. Write out the full National Pledge.
 3. List the people found on the 20 Naira (General Murtala Muhammed) and 50 Naira (Local Fishermen & Farmers) notes.
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WEEK 10: FAMOUS NIGERIANS IN HISTORY.

OBJECTIVES By the end of the lesson, pupils should be able to:

1. Identify three famous historical figures in Nigeria.
2. Describe the achievement of Queen Amina.
3. Explain who Mary Slessor was.
4. Mention the contribution of Funmilayo Ransome-Kuti.

CONTENT



1. Queen Amina of Zaria:

- She was a powerful warrior queen of the Hausa city of Zazzau (Zaria). She ruled in the 16th century.
- She is famous for leading men into war and building walls around the cities she conquered.
- She showed that women can be strong leaders and protectors. The walls are sometimes called "Amina's Walls."

2. King Jaja of Opobo:

- He was a former slave who became a rich merchant and King in the Niger Delta.
- He controlled the palm oil trade. He is a hero because he stood up to the British who tried to cheat him in trade.
- He was eventually exiled by the British, but his courage is remembered.

3. **Oba Ovonramwen (The Exile King):**

- He was the Oba of Benin when the British attacked in 1897. He tried to protect his kingdom's independence and culture.
- He was captured and sent into exile in Calabar, but he never bowed to British rule.
- His story teaches us about resistance.

4. **Mary Slessor:**

- She was a Scottish missionary who lived in Calabar. She is very famous and loved because she stopped the killing of twins.
- Before her, people thought twins were evil and killed them. She saved hundreds of babies and adopted many herself.
- She is called "Eka Kpukpru Owo" (mother of all) in Efik.

5. **Funmilayo Ransome-Kuti:**

- She was a teacher and a women's rights activist from Abeokuta.
- She was the first woman in Nigeria to drive a car.
- She fought for women to have the right to vote and led protests against unfair taxes on women by the Alake (King) and the British.
- She was also the mother of the famous musician Fela Kuti.

EVALUATION

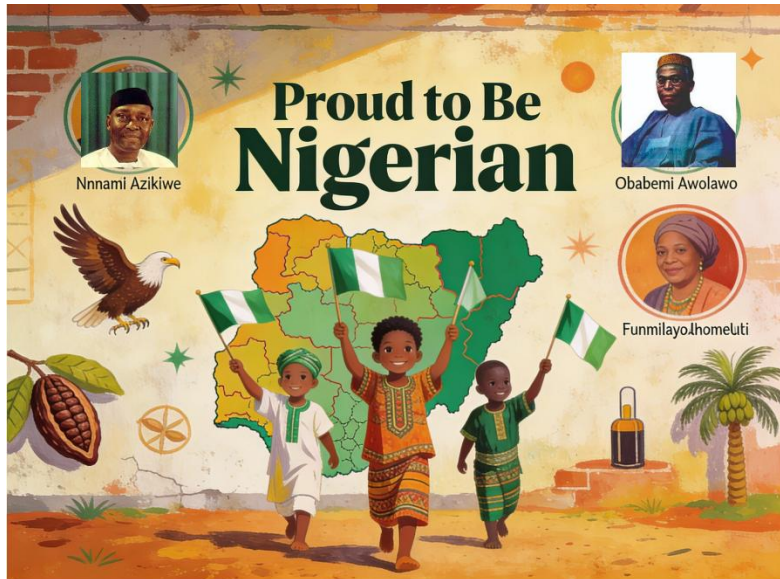
1. Who was the warrior Queen of Zaria?
2. What did Mary Slessor stop the people from doing?
3. Who was the first woman to drive a car in Nigeria?
4. Which King controlled the palm oil trade in Opobo?
5. Where was Oba Ovonramwen exiled to?
6. Mention one lesson we can learn from these heroes.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Match the name to the place:
 - Queen Amina -> Zaria
 - Mary Slessor -> Calabar
 - Funmilayo Ransome-Kuti -> Abeokuta
 2. Write one sentence about what you would like to be famous for in the future.
 3. Find a picture of any of these heroes and paste it in your book.
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WEEK 11: REVISION.



(Review all topics from Weeks 1-10. Focus on States/Capitals, Symbols, and Famous People. Prepare pupils for the end-of-year promotional examination).